

RP03

Rajasthan Legislative Assembly

About 3 questions a paper - the largest single chapter in Rajasthan Polity. Article 169 and the Legislative Council was asked in 2016 and 2021; the no-confidence motion threshold in 2016 and 2023.

Two hundred seats, thirty-four reserved for Scheduled Castes and twenty-five for Scheduled Tribes - that one line has appeared in more RAS papers than any other sentence in Rajasthan Polity. Around it sit the Speakers, the committees, the motions and the long-pending question of a Legislative Council.

Rajasthan Legislative Assembly

Composition

- 200 seats
- SC 34
- ST 25
- Jaipur 19 seats
- Jaisalmer and Pratapgarh 2 each

History

- Pratinidhi Sabha 1949
- First Assembly 1952, 160 seats
- 176 in 1956
- 184 in 1967
- 200 from 1977

Articles

- 168 constitution
- 169 Council
- 170 composition
- 172 five years
- 173 qualification
- 178-181 Speaker
- 189 quorum
- 194 privileges
- 199 Money Bill

Speakers

- Narottam Lal Joshi first
- Ram Niwas Mirdha longest
- Sumitra Singh first woman
- Vasudev Devnani current

Committees

- Public Accounts
- Public Undertakings
- Estimates A and B
- Privileges, Petitions, Assurances

Motions

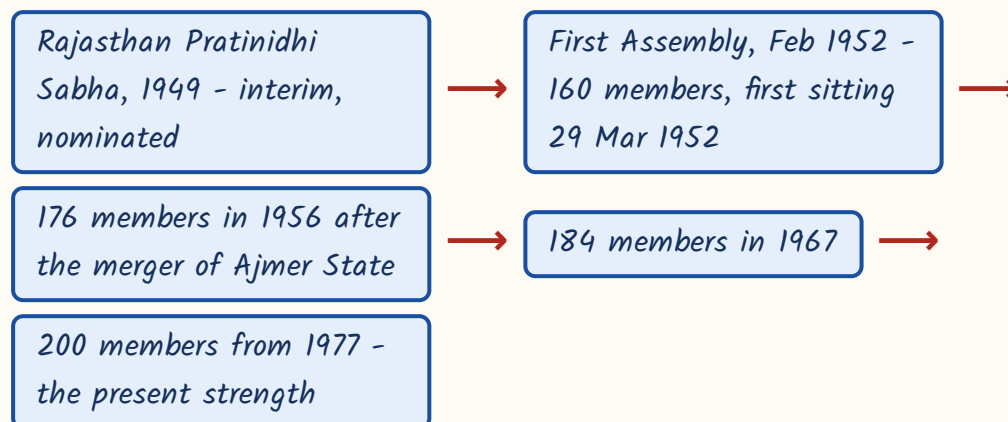
- No-confidence - 40 members
- None ever carried
- Confidence motion 14 Aug 2020

Where the Assembly came from

Rajasthan did not get an elected legislature the moment it was formed. When Vrihad Rajasthan came into being in 1949 there had to be some law-making body, so an interim legislature called the Rajasthan Pratinidhi Sabha was constituted in 1949. It was nominated, not elected. The elected Assembly came only after the first general election.

The first Rajasthan Legislative Assembly was constituted in February 1952 with 160 members, and held its first sitting on 29 March 1952 at the Sawai Man Singh Town Hall in Jaipur. The House then grew twice as territory and population changed, and reached its present strength of 200 in 1977. The present Vidhan Sabha building at Jyoti Nagar, Jaipur was inaugurated on 6 November 2001 by President K.R. Narayanan.

How the Assembly grew



- The Sixteenth Assembly was constituted after the election of 25 November 2023; results were declared on 3 December 2023 and the BJP won 115 seats.
- The Assembly Secretariat is headed by a Secretary appointed under Article 187.
- Rajasthan has adopted the National e-Vidhan Application, NeVA, for paperless proceedings.

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho the strength ladder - 160, 176, 184, 200, tied to 1952, 1956, 1967, 1977. The 1956 jump is the Ajmer merger; the 1977 figure has not changed since.

Composition and reservation - the most asked line in the chapter

Article 168 says the Legislature of a State consists of the Governor and one or two Houses. Rajasthan is unicameral - the Governor and the Legislative Assembly, nothing else. Article 170 fixes the outer limits for any State Assembly: not more than 500 members and not fewer than 60, chosen by direct election from territorial constituencies.

- Total strength of the Rajasthan Legislative Assembly - 200.
- Seats reserved for Scheduled Castes - 34.
- Seats reserved for Scheduled Tribes - 25.
- So 141 seats are unreserved.
- Jaipur district returns the largest number of members - 19.
- Jaisalmer and Pratapgarh return the fewest - 2 each.
- Article 332 provides the reservation of seats for SCs and STs in State Assemblies, extended periodically by constitutional amendment.
- The seats are reserved, the constituencies are not fixed for ever - they are redrawn at each delimitation.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre repeatedly, and set as a three-statement question in the recent pattern - the Assembly has 200 seats, 34 are reserved for Scheduled Castes and 25 for Scheduled Tribes. All three statements are correct. Learn 200-34-25 as one unit.

Do not let the two reservation numbers blur. Thirty-four is Scheduled Caste, twenty-five is Scheduled Tribe. Rajasthan's SC share of population is higher than its ST share, and the seat numbers follow the same order - SC more than ST.

Membership - who can sit, and who must leave

Article 173 lays down the qualifications. A member of the Legislative Assembly must be a citizen of India, must have completed 25 years of age, must take an oath before a person authorised by the Election Commission, and must have such other qualifications as Parliament prescribes - which come from the Representation of the People Act, 1951.

- Article 191 disqualification - holding an office of profit under the Union or a State Government.
- Being of unsound mind as declared by a competent court, or being an undischarged insolvent.
- Not being a citizen, or having voluntarily acquired the citizenship of a foreign State.
- Any disqualification under a law made by Parliament - chiefly the Representation of the People Act, 1951.
- Defection is a separate ground, under the Tenth Schedule; the Speaker decides those cases.
- Article 192 - the Governor decides all other questions of disqualification, and must obtain the opinion of the Election Commission and act according to it.
- Article 190 - a seat falls vacant if a member is absent from all meetings for 60 days without permission of the House.
- Article 193 - a person who sits or votes when disqualified is liable to a penalty of five hundred rupees per day.

TRAP

The minimum age for the Assembly is 25, not 30. Thirty is the Legislative Council and Rajya Sabha figure. A NOT-a-disqualification question in the bank uses exactly this - being under thirty is not a disqualification for the Vidhan Sabha.

Term, sessions and the vocabulary of the House

Article 172 gives the Assembly a term of five years from the date of its first meeting, unless dissolved earlier. During a national emergency Parliament may extend it by one year at a time, and in no case beyond six months after the emergency ends. Article 174 governs sessions - the Governor summons the House, and the gap between the last sitting of one session and the first sitting of the next cannot be more than six months.

Four words you must be able to define

Term	Meaning
Adjournment	Suspension of a sitting for a specified time - hours, days or weeks
Adjournment sine die	Ending a sitting without naming a day for reassembly
Prorogation	Ending a session of the House, done by the Governor
Dissolution	Ending the life of the existing Assembly; a new House must be elected

Prorogation vs Dissolution - the pair RPSC sets against each other

Prorogation	Dissolution
Ends a session; the House continues to exist	Ends the House itself
Ordered by the Governor under Article 174(2) (a)	Ordered by the Governor under Article 174(2) (b)
Pending Bills do not lapse	Bills pending in the Assembly lapse
Members remain members	Members cease to be members; a general election follows

- Article 189 - the quorum is one-tenth of the total membership, that is 20 members in Rajasthan.
- All questions are decided by a majority of members present and voting; the presiding officer has only a casting vote, exercised in case of a tie.
- Article 188 - every member takes an oath or affirmation before the Governor or a person appointed by him.
- There is no constitutional minimum number of sittings in a year; only the six-month gap rule applies.
- Article 176 - the Governor's special address to the House at the first session after each general election and at the first session of every year.

The Speaker and the Deputy Speaker

Article 178 says the Assembly shall as soon as may be choose two members to be Speaker and Deputy Speaker. They are elected by the House from among its own members. The Speaker is the guardian of the House - he interprets the rules, decides points of order, and his ruling cannot be questioned.

- Presides over sittings, maintains order, and adjourns the House if there is no quorum.
- Certifies whether a Bill is a Money Bill under Article 199 - and his certificate is final.

- Decides disqualification on the ground of defection under the Tenth Schedule.
 - Exercises a casting vote only in case of a tie - he does not vote in the first instance.
 - Is the final authority on the admissibility of motions, questions and resolutions.
 - Nominates members to committees and appoints their chairmen; presides over the Business Advisory Committee.
 - Article 187 - the Assembly Secretariat functions under him.
 - The Speaker's salary and allowances are charged on the Consolidated Fund of the State.
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- Article 179 - the Speaker vacates office if he ceases to be a member of the Assembly.
 - He may resign in writing addressed to the Deputy Speaker.
 - He may be removed by a resolution passed by a majority of ALL the then members of the Assembly.
 - Fourteen days' advance notice of such a resolution is compulsory.
 - Article 181 - the Speaker does not preside when a resolution for his own removal is under consideration.
 - He may still speak in and take part in those proceedings, and vote in the first instance - but not a casting vote.
 - A Speaker whose Assembly is dissolved continues in office until immediately before the first meeting of the new Assembly.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre style - the removal of the Speaker of the Rajasthan Legislative Assembly needs a resolution passed by a majority of all the then members, after 14 days' notice. A simple majority of those present and voting is the wrong option.

The Speakers of Rajasthan - names, firsts and records

Learn the four anchors first - the first Speaker, the longest-serving Speaker, the first woman Speaker and the present Speaker. Then attach the Assembly numbers to the rest. RPSC sets this as a match question and as an odd-man-out.

Speakers whose periods are directly examinable

Speaker	Period	Assembly
Narottam Lal Joshi	31 Mar 1952 - 25 Apr 1957	First - the first Speaker of Rajasthan
Ram Niwas Mirdha	1957 - 1967	Second and Third - longest-serving Speaker
Hari Shankar Bhabhra	from 1990	Ninth
Parasram Maderna	from 1999	Eleventh
Sumitra Singh	2004 - 2009	Twelfth - first woman Speaker, from Jhunjhunu
Kailash Chandra Meghwal	2014 - 2019	Fourteenth
C.P. Joshi	2019 - 2023	Fifteenth
Vasudev Devnani	from 21 Dec 2023	Sixteenth - the present Speaker

- Other Speakers include Niranjana Nath Acharya, Ram Kishore Vyas, Laxman Singh and Poonam Chand Vishnoi.
- Also Hira Lal Devpura, Giriraj Prasad Tiwari, Shanti Lal Chaplot, Samrath Lal Meena and Deependra Singh Shekhawat.
- Hira Lal Devpura is the only person to have been both Chief Minister and Speaker of Rajasthan - Chief Minister for a fortnight in February-March 1985, and Speaker later the same month.

- *Ram Niwas Mirdha was a Speaker, never a Chief Minister - he is used as a distractor in the Chief Ministers question.*
- *Chronological order for the ordering question - Mirdha 1957, Maderna 1999, Sumitra Singh 2004, C.P. Joshi 2019.*

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a match of office to first holder - first Speaker Narottam Lal Joshi, first woman Speaker Sumitra Singh, first Governor Gurmukh Nihal Singh, first Chief Minister Heera Lal Shastri. All four firsts in one question.

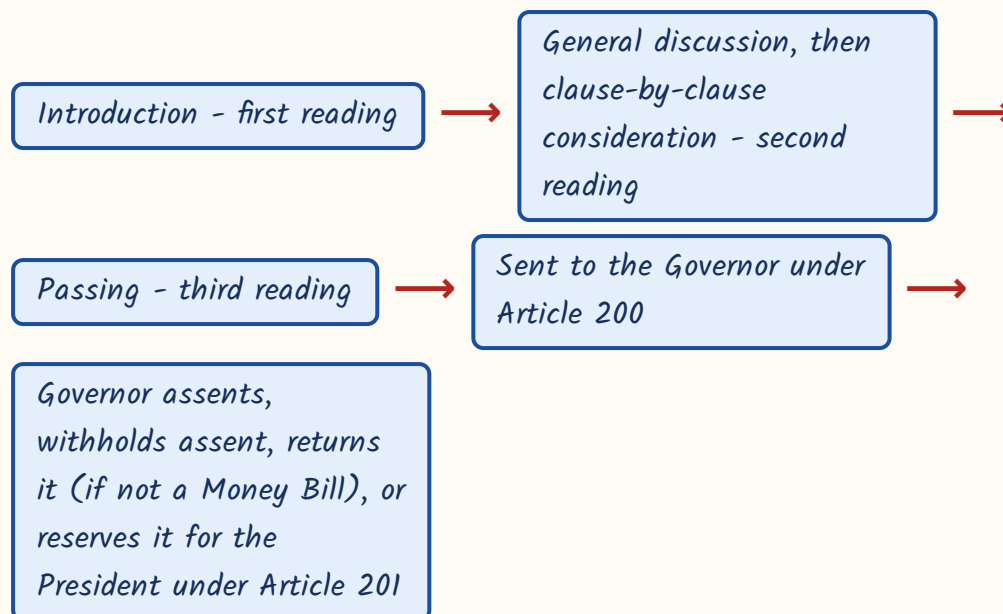
TRAP

Kailash Chandra Meghwal was Speaker of the FOURTEENTH Assembly, 2014-2019. The Fifteenth Assembly's Speaker was C.P. Joshi. The NOT-correctly-matched question in 2023 turned on exactly this swap.

Legislative procedure, Money Bills and the budget

In a unicameral State the passage of a Bill is short. It is introduced in the Assembly, goes through three readings, and then goes to the Governor. There is no second chamber to revise it and no joint sitting, because there is nothing to sit jointly with.

An ordinary Bill in Rajasthan



- Article 199 defines a Money Bill - taxation, borrowing, the Consolidated or Contingency Fund of the State.
- It also covers appropriation, expenditure charged on the Consolidated Fund, and the audit of State accounts.
- A Money Bill can be introduced only in the Legislative Assembly, and only on the recommendation of the Governor.
- The Speaker's certificate that a Bill is a Money Bill is final and cannot be questioned in any court.
- The Governor cannot return a Money Bill for reconsideration - he assents or reserves it.
- Article 202 - the annual financial statement, the state budget, is laid before the House on the Governor's direction.
- Article 203 - demands for grants are voted by the Assembly; charged expenditure is not put to vote.
- Article 204 - the Appropriation Bill follows the voting of demands.
- Article 207 - no financial Bill of certain classes can be introduced or moved except on the Governor's recommendation.

TRAP

Do not carry Parliament's rules across. There is no Rajya Sabha equivalent here, so no 14-day return period, no joint sitting under Article 108, and no Council to delay a Money Bill - Rajasthan has only one House.

Committees of the Rajasthan Legislative Assembly

The House cannot examine every rupee and every rule on the floor. It works through committees, and RPSC likes to ask which committee is a financial committee and which is not. Rajasthan has four financial committees - remember four, not three, because the Estimates Committee is split into A and B.

The four financial committees

Committee	What it does
Public Accounts Committee	Examines the CAG's audit reports and the appropriation accounts of the State
Committee on Public Undertakings	Examines the working, reports and accounts of State public undertakings
Estimates Committee A	Examines the budget estimates of the departments allotted to it
Estimates Committee B	Examines the estimates of the remaining departments

- Maximum strength of a committee - 15 members.
- A Minister can neither chair nor be a member of a financial committee.
- Committees are normally reconstituted every year.
- Members are elected or nominated from among the members of the Assembly; the Speaker appoints the chairmen.

- Other committees include Subordinate Legislation, Privileges, Petitions and Government Assurances.
- Also the Rules Committee, the Committee on Women and Children, and the Committee on the Welfare of SCs and STs.
- The Committee of Privileges is a House committee, not a financial committee - that is the standard NOT-in-the-list answer.
- Article 194 - powers, privileges and immunities of the House, its committees and its members.
- Article 212 - courts cannot inquire into the proceedings of the Legislature on the ground of irregularity of procedure.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre style - which is NOT a financial committee of the Rajasthan Legislative Assembly? Answer: the Committee on Privileges. The four financial ones are Public Accounts, Public Undertakings and Estimates A and B.

Motions, and the Legislative Council that never came

A no-confidence motion is the Assembly's ultimate weapon against the Council of Ministers. In Rajasthan it can be admitted only if at least one-fifth of the total membership supports it - one-fifth of 200 is 40 members. Once admitted and carried, the whole Council of Ministers must resign. Note the record: no no-confidence motion has ever been carried in the Rajasthan Legislative Assembly.

- A confidence motion is the opposite - moved by the Government itself to demonstrate its majority.
- Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot won a confidence motion by voice vote on 14 August 2020, during that year's political crisis.

- An adjournment motion raises a definite matter of urgent public importance and carries an element of censure of the Government.
- A calling-attention notice draws a Minister's attention to a matter of urgent public importance and carries no censure.
- A censure motion can be moved against an individual Minister; a no-confidence motion is only against the Council as a whole.
- Cut motions - policy cut, economy cut and token cut - are moved at the demands-for-grants stage.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and again in 2023 - a no-confidence motion in the Rajasthan Legislative Assembly needs the support of at least 40 members for admission, and the number of such motions carried so far is nil.

Now Article 169, a documented repeat from 2016 and 2021. Parliament may by law create a Legislative Council in a State that does not have one, or abolish one that does, but only if the Legislative Assembly of that State first passes a resolution - by a majority of the total membership of the Assembly AND by not less than two-thirds of the members present and voting. Such a law is not treated as an amendment of the Constitution under Article 368, so it goes through as an ordinary law.

- On 18 April 2012 the Rajasthan Legislative Assembly passed a resolution under Article 169 for a 66-member Legislative Council.
- The Rajasthan Legislative Council Bill, 2013 was introduced in Parliament but has never been enacted.
- Rajasthan therefore remains unicameral - the Governor and the Legislative Assembly only.
- Parliament is not bound to act on the Assembly's resolution; the resolution enables, it does not compel.

- Article 171 governs the composition of a Council where one exists - total strength not more than one-third of the Assembly's strength and not less than 40.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - under which Article may Parliament create or abolish a State Legislative Council? Answer: Article 169. The companion statement question adds that such a law is not deemed an amendment under Article 368.

Motions and devices at a glance

Device	Aimed at	Key condition
No-confidence motion	The whole Council of Ministers	Support of 40 members for admission
Confidence motion	Moved by the Government itself	To demonstrate its own majority
Censure motion	An individual Minister or the Council	Must state the grounds
Adjournment motion	Government policy	Definite matter of urgent public importance, implies censure
Calling attention	A Minister	No element of censure

YAAD RAKHO

Two fractions, two different purposes. One-fifth of the House - 40 members - admits a no-confidence motion. Two-thirds of those present and voting plus a majority of total membership - that is the Article 169 resolution. Both throw up the number 40 in Rajasthan, which is exactly why they get confused.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the Sixteenth Assembly is in office, Vasudev Devnani (BJP, Ajmer North) is Speaker since 21 December 2023 and Tika Ram Jolly (Congress, Alwar Rural) is Leader of the Opposition since January 2024. The Legislative Council Bill of 2013 is still pending - if Parliament moves on it before December 2026 it becomes a certain question.

REVISION RECAP

1. 200 seats; SC 34, ST 25 - the single most repeated line in Rajasthan Polity.
2. Jaipur district sends 19 members, the most; Jaisalmer and Pratapgarh 2 each, the fewest.
3. Rajasthan Pratinidhi Sabha, 1949, was the interim legislature before the elected Assembly.
4. First Assembly constituted February 1952 with 160 members; first sitting 29 March 1952 at Sawai Man Singh Town Hall, Jaipur.
5. Strength ladder - 160 in 1952, 176 in 1956 after the Ajmer merger, 184 in 1967, 200 from 1977.
6. Present Vidhan Sabha building at Jyoti Nagar inaugurated 6 November 2001 by President K.R. Narayanan.
7. Article 168 constitution of the State Legislature; 170 composition, maximum 500 and minimum 60; 172 five-year term.
8. Article 173 - citizen of India, 25 years of age; Article 191 disqualifications; Article 192 the Governor decides, on the EC's opinion.
9. Article 190 - a seat falls vacant on 60 days' absence without permission; the Tenth Schedule handles defection, decided by the Speaker.
10. Article 189 - quorum is one-tenth, that is 20 members; the presiding officer has only a casting vote.
11. Article 174 - maximum gap between sessions six months; Article 176 the Governor's special address.
12. Speaker's removal - resolution by a majority of all the then members, 14 days' notice, Article 179; he does not preside then, Article 181.
13. Narottam Lal Joshi first Speaker 1952-57; Ram Niwas Mirdha longest 1957-67; Sumitra Singh first woman, Twelfth Assembly.

14. Kailash Chandra Meghwal - Fourteenth Assembly; C.P. Joshi - Fifteenth; Vasudev Devnani - Sixteenth, from December 2023.
15. Article 199 defines a Money Bill; only in the Assembly, only on the Governor's recommendation, certified by the Speaker, not returnable.
16. Four financial committees - Public Accounts, Public Undertakings, Estimates A and Estimates B; maximum 15 members; no Ministers.
17. Privileges, Petitions, Subordinate Legislation, Government Assurances, Rules, Women and Children, SC-ST Welfare are the other committees.
18. No-confidence motion needs 40 members - one-fifth of 200 - to be admitted; none has ever been carried in Rajasthan.
19. Ashok Gehlot won a confidence motion by voice vote on 14 August 2020.
20. Article 169 - the 2012 resolution sought a 66-member Council; the 2013 Bill lapsed unenacted, so Rajasthan stays unicameral.